



"Daughter of Tragedy",
January 7, 2008

"Bhutto's death is only a reaffirmation of the hard fact that it's a man's world, where no woman can afford to challenge a male, that too in uniform."

RAJNEESH BATRA, *Delhi*

Paying the Price

Pakistani people have lost faith in President Musharraf ("Daughter of Tragedy", January 7). There is no other viable leader left apart from Nawaz Sharif. With Benazir Bhutto gone, Pakistan is on the brink of a disaster.

ANUSHA SINGH SAHARAN, *Delhi*

Bhutto displayed tremendous courage in returning to her strife-torn country. In her, Pakistan has lost its strongest proponent of democracy.

VIRENDRA KUMAR TANGRI,
Dehradun

The special report on Bhutto's assassination reminded one of Rajiv Gandhi's death, which took place on our own soil. It shows that playing politics is like riding a man-eating tiger.

A. JACOB SAHAYAM,
Thiruvananthapuram

Those who live by the sword, die by it. Though Bhutto's death is tragic, her role in aiding and abetting the Taliban and thereby terrorism cannot be denied.

AJOY KUMAR MOHTA, *Kolkata*

Pakistan was founded as an Islamic state and Islam does not offer much scope for democracy to thrive, much less to a woman to shed the veil and lead a nation. Bhutto, hailed as the daughter of the East, has paid the price for taking on the mullahs.

MEGHANA A., *Hyderabad*

The killing of a dynamic and charismatic leader like Bhutto, who was channelising the people's voice and wishes in the right direction, has led to several hearts throbbing in fear not only in Pakistan, but the entire world.

DEEPAK KUMAR,
Begusarai, Bihar

Bhutto's barbaric death is proof of the sorry state of affairs in politics today. It also speaks volumes about the poor security provided to high-profile individuals.

ABHILASHA RAO,
Sambalpur, Orissa

Her self-imposed exile and then her subsequent return to Pakistan at the time of elections, show that Bhutto was an opportunist. She may not have chosen this life, but she did blemish it by preferring to flee the country when it needed her the most.

SANJEEV TRIKHA,
Fatehabad, Haryana

Bhutto was ultimately caught in her own web. She tried to destabilise India by promoting militancy in Kashmir, something which killed her. She joined hands with the US, which resulted in her destruction.

SHRUTI AMAR, *Bhagalpur*

Communalism Rules

The anti-Christian violence in Orissa led by Hindu extremist organisations like VHP and RSS is proof of the influence wielded by these outfits ("Faith Attack", January 7). There is no reason why Dalits should not be allowed to follow the religion of their choice. The increasing level of intolerance in the country should be curbed and all extremist Hindu organisations be banned.

ANTHONY FERNANDES, *Mumbai*

Not Worth Reading

It is good that lessons on Lalu Prasad Yadav have been deleted from school books in Bihar ("No More Lessons", January 7). The state will only gain by banishing one of its most infamous men from its children's textbooks. Despite the hype, Lalu will not be treated kindly by history.

T.S. PATTABHI RAMAN,
Coimbatore